

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

TUESDAY, DECEMBER 10, 2024

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Police arrest man in killing of CEO

Suspect detained in Pennsylvania with gun, cops report

By Michael R. Sisak and Cedar Attanasio
Associated Press

NEW YORK — Police arrested a “strong person of interest” Monday in the Manhattan killing of UnitedHealthcare’s CEO after a McDonald’s customer and employee in Pennsylvania alerted authorities to another customer who was found with a weapon and writings linking him to the ambush, authorities said.

The suspect, identified by police as Luigi Nicholas Mangione, 26, had a gun believed to be the one

used in Wednesday’s shooting of Brian Thompson, as well as writings suggesting anger with corporate America, police said. He was charged with weapons, forgery and other charges, authorities said later Monday.

Mangione was taken into custody about 9:15 a.m. after police got a tip that he was eating at a McDonald’s in Altoona, Pennsylvania, police said.

“He is believed to be our person of interest in the brazen, targeted murder of Brian Thompson,” NYPD Commissioner Jessica Tisch said.

Mangione had clothing and a mask similar to those worn by the shooter and a fraudulent New Jersey ID matching one the suspect used to check into a New York City hostel before the shooting, Tisch said.

NYPD Chief of Detectives Joseph Kenny said Mangione was born and raised in Maryland, has ties to San Francisco and a last known address in Honolulu, Hawaii. A message left Monday with a Philadelphia-area phone number connected to Mangi-

Turn to Suspect, Page 8



Luigi Mangione is escorted by police to his arraignment at the Blair County Courthouse in Hollidaysburg, Pennsylvania, on Monday.
RACHEL WISNIEWSKI/THE NEW YORK TIMES



Equipment stands on Monday at Sims Metal Management’s facility in Chicago’s Pilsen neighborhood. E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

City delays permitting on scrap metal shredder

Pilsen residents feel neglected as deadline missed on decision for renewal

By Karina Atkins
Chicago Tribune

Missing its own deadline Monday, the city yet again delayed a decision on the fate of a scrap metal shredder in Pilsen with a history of environmental violations. The permit is largely retroactive at this point, cover-

ing operations from 2021 to 2024, but the city’s inaction has left the shredder’s neighbors concerned for their health.

Sims Metal Management’s operating permit for its facility at 2500 S. Paulina St. expired in November 2021. A month earlier, it was sued by Illinois Attorney General Kwame Raoul for failing

to show it was reducing air pollution there. This came after Sims was fined in 2018 by the U.S. EPA for emitting high levels of harmful particulate matter.

Data from five EPA-mandated air pollution monitors installed in 2022 have consistently shown that pollution from the facility is below levels that would cause

short- or long-term health consequences. The city is weighing this data heavily as it makes the permitting decision, Department of Public Health Commissioner Olusimbo Ige told concerned community leaders during a private meeting Friday.

Turn to Permit, Page 4

MICHAEL MADIGAN TRIAL

‘Sphinx’ nickname revealed to jury

US Rep. Budzinski, former Pritzker aide, testifies before recess

By Jason Meisner and Megan Crepeau
Chicago Tribune

The jury in Michael Madigan’s corruption trial has heard many nicknames given to the powerful Democratic House Speaker, from the obvious, like “MJM” or “Mr. Speaker,” to the more esoteric, such as “Himself” and “our Friend.”

On Monday they heard a new one: “Sphinx.”

That was the moniker applied to Madigan by some members of JB Pritzker’s team after Pritzker’s election in 2018, according to U.S. Rep. Nikki Budzinski, D-Ill., who was a top Pritzker aide before her election to Congress in 2022.

The nickname, a reference to the mythical figure of Egyptian pharaohs typically used to convey strength and ferocity — and in modern times to suggest someone can be hard to read — was used in an email shown during Budzinski’s testimony referencing a job recommendation from Madigan for Pritzker’s new administration.

“Attached is the most recent Sphinx list of recommendations ahead of your meeting today,” read the Dec. 4, 2018, email, sent from Budzinski to Pritzker and his soon-to-be chief of staff, Anne Caprara. “We have noted these in our process and they are coming thru our portal.”

It’s not the first time Madigan was referred to as Sphinx in political circles. In fact, some of the speaker’s own friends

Turn to Madigan, Page 4

Mayor says vote in Texas ‘personal’

Mayor Brandon Johnson declined to weigh in on the fact that his top adviser voted last month in Texas, saying any questions about whether it was improper for him to cast his ballot in Houston are the responsibility of election officials there.
Chicagoland, Page 3

Economic study: Ill. better prepared

The state is in better shape to withstand an economic downturn than it was during either the 2007 Great Recession or the 2020 COVID recession, a new economic study has found. **Business**

‘Hero’ cop from French shooting faces firing



A police officer with the image of fellow Officer Ella French in his hat attends funeral services for French on Aug. 19, 2021, at St. Rita of Cascia Shrine Chapel in Chicago. ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Officer has had legal troubles, now confronts administrative charges

By Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

On Aug. 7, 2021, Chicago police Officer Thomas Raap rose to the occasion.

That night, a traffic stop ended in tragedy near 63rd and Bell in West Englewood. Officer Ella French was shot and killed, and her partner, Carlos Yanez, was shot in the head and critically wounded.

CPD officers soon swarmed the area. Four of them picked up Yanez from the pavement and put him in a squad car. Raap jumped in

the vehicle too.

He talked with Yanez, reassuring him, as another officer drove “like a bat out of hell” east on 63rd Street toward the University of Chicago Medical Center in Hyde Park. Raap, 31, and other responding officers were later honored for heroism by the Fraternal Order of Police, as well as Gov. JB Pritzker and the Illinois State Police.

But now CPD is seeking to fire Raap, who, in the years since the shooting, has faced persistent legal trouble.

CPD’s effort to fire him stems from his alleged failure of a drug test in July 2022. CPD says his urine contained traces of cocaine.

FOP President John Catanzara,

Turn to Raap, Page 2

